Familiarize yourself with phishing attacks.

(Most targeted departments that take the bait)

What is phishing?

- Phishing is a cyberattack where an attacker impersonates a trusted entity to trick users into revealing sensitive information or clicking malicious links.

LEARN TO SPOT PHISHING EMAIL.

Tactics used by attackers to create a phishing email.

- **Impersonation** – Pretending to be a trusted company or person
- **Urgency** – Creating pressure to act quickly
- **Fear/Threats** – Warning of account suspension or loss
- **Curiosity** – Using tempting or vague messages
- **Generic Greetings** – Avoiding personal details (“Dear User”)
- **Malicious Links** – Directing users to fake login pages
- **Attachments** – Sending infected files (PDF, ZIP, DOC)
- **Look-alike Domains** – Using fake domains similar to real ones
- **Spoofed Sender Address** – Forged “From” email address
- **Too-Good-to-Be-True Offers** – Fake rewards, refunds, or prizes

How do we stop getting phished?

Tips and hints to stay vigilant about phishing.

- **Check the sender's email address** – Look for misspellings or fake domains
- **Hover over links** – Verify the real URL before clicking
- **Be cautious with urgency** – Pressure is a common phishing tactic
- **Avoid unexpected attachments** – Especially ZIP, PDF, or DOC files
- **Look for generic greetings** – Legitimate emails usually personalize
- **Watch for spelling and grammar errors** – Often a red flag
- **Never share credentials by email** – Real companies don't ask for this
- **Verify requests independently** – Contact the sender through official channels
- **Use multi-factor authentication (MFA)** – Reduces impact if credentials are stolen
- **Report suspicious emails** – Helps protect others